

Seven Patriots: The Vandivort Family in the American Revolution

July 4th, 2026

This document was developed to help the Vandivort Descendants celebrate the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence. It marks a historic milestone in the story of the United States, commemorating two and one half centuries since the nation's founders proclaimed liberty, equality and self-government on July 4, 1776. The Vandivort Family has many Patriots ancestors who helped lay the foundation of the United States through their perseverance, courage, and sacrifice. We can proudly remember and celebrate the enduring legacy of these Vandivort Patriots and honor their vision of liberty, equality and democracy.

The following information is drawn from sources on Family Search, Ancestry.com and the extensive notes of Julia Sanford Vandivort as compiled by Paul Stein. We owe a huge debt of thanks to Paul Stein for compiling Grandma Vandivort's extensive and complex notes in "Clyde Arthur and Julia Sanford Vandivort of Cape Girardeau, Missouri: Their Ancestors and Descendants". And of course, we must thank my Grandmother, Julia Sanford Vandivort, who did all this vast genealogical work before the internet, scanners and copy machines.

The following Revolutionary War Patriots are all recognized Patriots by the **Daughters of the American Revolution (DAR)** under Julia Sanford Vandivort's membership (DAR#188056), although detailed information about their military service includes newer research.

Julia Vandivort explained her feelings about her genealogical work in *The Heritage*: "Hold me not boastful that I take pride in what my forefathers achieved. I honor not myself but them who gave a priceless heritage on which to build, not selfishness, for they knew sacrifice; not cowardice, but courage for the right; not boldness, but a quiet dignity; not false pride, but a love of high ideals, and reverence for things to be revered. Heir to these qualities, so may I prove more worthy of the good blood that flows in me."





A map of Patriot service sites across the Thirteen Colonies — see the legend for each ancestor

★ Seven Patriots, in the Order They Served ★

A Country Goes to War: Spring 1775

By the time fighting broke out at Lexington and Concord in April 1775, the thirteen colonies had been drifting toward war for the better part of a decade. News of the bloodshed spread fast, and within weeks colonial assemblies up and down the coast were transforming themselves from political bodies into wartime governments, raising militia, and electing delegates to provincial congresses that increasingly answered to no one but themselves. Massachusetts, the colony at the center of the storm, had to manage all of this even in its farthest-flung corner: the District of Maine, more than a hundred miles up the coast from Boston, where a young Harvard-trained lawyer named Timothy Langdon had spent the better part of a decade building a career and a family.

1. Timothy Langdon 1746 – 1808

Timothy Langdon was born on November 7, 1746, in Boston, Massachusetts. He married Sarah Vance on July 13, 1771, in Wiscasset, Maine (then part of Massachusetts). They were the parents of at least 2 daughters. He died in 1808, in Wiscasset, Maine, at the age of 62. According to Grandma's notes, his brother was governor of Massachusetts. His 4th great grandfather came to America from Devon, England.

Timothy Langdon was a member of the graduated class of Harvard in 1765. Langdon soon received an appointment as a Crown Lawyer and, for many years, was the only lawyer in Wiscasset. Later, John Adams was another judicial lawyer who traveled the Maine Circuit. Timothy Langdon was identified early with the cause of the colonies and for several years served as a member of the committee of correspondence of the town for Pownalborough. In May 1775, he was chosen to represent the town in the Third Provincial Congress which met in 1776 in Watertown. He also served in the Boston Suffolk Company. In 1775, he was Captain of a company stationed in Boothbay for seacoast defense from July to December 1775.

Grandma has a poignant note about Timothy Langdon: "Dissipation proved his undoing. Losing business in Wiscasset, he went to Norridgewock in 1793. Later he went to Farmington, where he remained for about 6 years. He died in Hallawell in 1808. He was found dead, sitting in a chair."

Lineage: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Joseph William Russell > Mary Langdon Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Mary Langdon > Timothy Langdon

Patriots in Divided Colonies

American colonists were deeply divided, not united. Historians estimated only about one-third of the population actively supported the Patriots. The Loyalists represented around 20% of the population. A large middle group tried to avoid the conflict entirely, often shifting sides depending on which army was nearby. Especially in the early days of the American Revolution, it was as much a bitter civil war between neighbors as it was a fight for independence from Britain.

A Royal Governor's Last Stand: 1776

While Langdon kept watch over the Maine coast, the political ground was shifting beneath everyone's feet. By the summer of 1776, the colonies had declared independence outright, and nowhere was the old order collapsing, no where more visibly than in Virginia, where the royal governor, Lord Dunmore, had been reduced to commanding a desperate, disease-ravaged flotilla of loyalist refugees rather than a colony.

2. Jarvis Daugherty & William Daugherty 1722–1814 / 1763–1805

Jarvis Daugherty was born in 1722 in Floyd, Virginia (Grandma states he was born in Wales but other sources do not support this). He married Elizabeth Morgan in 1754. They had five children in 15 years of marriage. He died on March 7, 1814, in Virginia at the impressive age of 92. Jarvis's 3rd great grandfather came from Donegal, Ireland, most likely of Scots Irish lineage.

Jarvis served with his son, William Daugherty. William Daugherty was born on March 17, 1763. He married Elizabeth Ramsey in 1796, in Missouri. They were the parents of at least 2 sons and 1 daughter. He died about 1805, in Missouri, at the age of 42. According to the Houch History of Southeast Mo, Vol II, page 186, William Daugherty settled in Southeast Missouri in 1798 and was given a Spanish land grant near Jackson.

In 1776, both Jarvis and William served in a Virginia company commanded by Captain Alexander Machir. Captain Alexander Machir commanded a company of militia from the Strasburg District of Dunmore County (later Shenandoah County), Virginia, during the American Revolutionary War in the 1770s. His company had 45 men in November 1775, but Captain Machir complained that some residents failed to muster due to religious objections (Mennonites). Jarvis and William were serving in the Virginia militia during the period when Patriots attacked Virginia Governor Dunmore's forces on Gwynn's Island, July 9, 1776, although there is no specific documentation of their involvement. The Governor, who was a British loyalist, was wounded in the battle and immediately left for New York which was a British stronghold. The Patriots had chased away the British Governor of Virginia!

Lineage: [Julia Sanford Vandivort](#) > [Linus Sanford](#) > [Mary Daugherty](#) > [William Daugherty](#) > [Jarvis Daugherty](#)

The War Comes Home: Spring 1777

By 1777, the British had given up trying to win the war with a single decisive stroke and had turned instead to a strategy of punishment, sending fast-moving raiding forces to destroy American supply depots and terrorize the coastline rather than hold ground. The first major target was a Continental Army storehouse in Danbury, Connecticut.

3. Daniel Sanford 1729 – 1793

Daniel Sanford was born on January 6, 1729, in New Haven, Connecticut Colony. He married Thankful Tolles on January 31, 1753, in Waterbury, Connecticut. Daniel and Thankful were the parents of at least 3 sons and 5 daughters. Daniel died on August 5, 1793, in Plymouth Hollow, Litchfield, Connecticut, at the age of 64, and was buried in Plymouth Hollow. The Sanford lineage includes ancestors in Hertfordshire and Essex, England, although we don't have records dating back to England for the Daniel Sanford line.

Daniel fought at the Danbury Alarm in the State Regiment under Generals Spencer and Wooster, in the First Battalion under Colonel Samuel White; Lieutenant Colonel-Samuel Canfield; Major-Stephen St. John. On April 25, 1777, a British force under the command of the Royal Governor of the Province of New York, Major General William Tryon, landed between Fairfield and Norwalk, Connecticut. The British military then began a march from there to Danbury, Connecticut, where the Patriots had an extensive depot of supplies. On their way to Danbury, the main battle was in the village of Ridgefield, Connecticut, on April 27. Daniel's Company fought in this battle of the Danbury Alarm; and he perhaps also fought in more skirmishing the next day between Ridgefield and the coastline near modern Westport, Connecticut.

According to Grandma Vandivort notes: "In 'The Connecticut Men of the Revolution', p 493, it states that Daniel was taken prisoner and carried to New Haven as a casualty of the Danbury Alarm, April 1777".

Unfortunately, the British did reach Danbury and, after chasing off a small garrison of troops, the British destroyed the extensive Continental Army supplies.

Lineage: Julia Sanford > Linus Sanford > Henry Sanford > Eli Sanford > Daniel Sanford

Washington's Army Bleeds for Philadelphia: Autumn 1777

Even as Connecticut's militia turned back Tryon's raiders, the main armies under Washington and Howe were locked in a much larger contest for the Continental Congress's own capital. That summer, Howe had landed his army south of Philadelphia and fought his way north, winning a brutal, costly battle at Brandywine in September before occupying the city itself. The fighting did not end there.

4. Joseph Russell 1757 – 1817

Joseph Russell was born on June 23, 1757, in Frederick, Virginia. He married Margaret Campbell in 1777, in Virginia. They were the parents of at least 5 sons and 1 daughter. He died on May 27, 1817, in Hawkins, Tennessee, at the age of 59, and was buried in Old Presbyterian Church Cemetery, Rogersville, Tennessee.

Joseph Russell served in Captain Benjamin Harrison's Volunteer Company from Fauquier County, Virginia from September to November 1777. The company marched from Fauquier Courthouse under the command of Maj. Martin Pickett and joined Washington's army near Germantown on Oct 5, 1777. They were attached to the 3rd Virginia Continental Regiment commanded by Colonel Thomas Marshall. They likely fought in the Battle of Germantown, on October 4, 1777, at Germantown, Pennsylvania. This was a battle between the British Army led by Sir William Howe and the American Continental Army under George Washington. Unfortunately, a heavy fog confused the Patriot forces and the British outflanked American General Greene. Colonel Thomas's 3rd Virginia Continental Regiment arrived late but was able to cover the retreat of the Continental Army. Major Pickett discharged the troops at White Plains NY at the end of November 1777.

Lineage: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Martha Jane Russell > Joseph William Russell > James Russell > Joseph Russell

Battle of Germantown: October 4th, 1777

The Battle of Germantown was a daring but ultimately unsuccessful attempt to take back Philadelphia from the British occupation. Washington sought to take advantage of the fact that General Howe split his forces. The surprise attack by the Continentals initially did quite well, but the dense fog caused severe confusion. The British were able to counter-attack and caused retreat. Nonetheless, French observers were impressed with the audacity of the effort and helped convince them that the American Army was a viable fighting force.

A War Without a Coastline: 1778–1781

While the armies maneuvered on land, a different front had been quietly building since nearly the start of the war: an irregular, profitable, and dangerous campaign waged at sea by privately owned ships authorized to attack British shipping. By the late 1770s, American privateers, sailing under commissions issued by Congress and the states, had become a serious thorn in Britain's side, harassing merchant convoys from the Caribbean to the English Channel and driving up insurance costs on British trade to levels not seen since the previous war with France.

5. Captain Benjamin Frizell c.1735 – 1795

Captain Benjamin Frizzell was born about 1735, in Wiscasset, now in Maine (during this time, Maine was part of the Massachusetts Colony). He married Mary Silvester in 1758, at Lincoln, Maine. They were the parents of at least 7 sons and 5 daughters. He was one of the founders of the Lincoln Lodge of Masons in Pownalborough, Maine. He died from drowning on December 3, 1795, in Liverpool, England, at the age of 61. He is buried in Toxteth, Liverpool, Merseyside, England. There is some evidence to indicate he had Scottish heritage.

Captain Benjamin Frizzell registered for military service in 1778. On July 31, 1781, he became the Commander of the Galley Reprisal, a privateer vessel. The infant Continental Navy only started in October 1775 with about ten ships, none of which were built for warfare. On April 3, 1777, the Continental Congress authorized commissions to owners of private ships to enhance the Continental Naval resources by authorizing these ships to attack English ships. These privateers attacked British ships in the Caribbean and in the English Channel as well as in U.S. coastal waters.

Each license entitled those commissioned to seize and auction off the English cargo, with half the proceeds to go to the shipowner while the other half went to the captain and crew. They hunted alone or in small packs, often targeting British mercantile ships rather than heavily armed British war ships. Although this work was lucrative when successful, it was quite dangerous as sailors captured by the English were imprisoned as rebels under cruel circumstances. Over the course of the War, over 2,200 British merchant ships were seized. John Paul Jones and other people later recognized as heroes by the US Navy began their careers as privateers.

Lineage: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Joseph William Russell > Mary Langdon Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Benjamin Frizell

A Second Try at New England's Coast: Summer 1779

Even as privateers like Frizell harassed British shipping at sea, the British tried once more to break the will of New England's coastal towns directly, this time aiming for a target larger than Danbury: the city of New Haven itself, the same town where Daniel Sanford had been marched as a prisoner two years before.

6. Captain Timothy Baldwin 1722 – 1800

Timothy Baldwin was born on December 13, 1722, in Paugasset, New Haven County, Connecticut Colony. He married Sarah Beecher on January 15, 1744, in Paugasset. They were the parents of at least 2 sons and 2 daughters. He died on December 22, 1800, in his hometown, at the age of 78, and was buried in Paugasset, Connecticut. The Baldwin name is associated with the Norman conquest of 1066, and is seen in England, Scotland and Ireland.

Timothy Baldwin served as a Captain in the Connecticut militia. Captain Baldwin's company was part of the local response to British raids, most notably during the British invasion of New Haven in July 1779. On July 5–6, 1779, British forces led by Major General William Tryon and Brigadier General George Garth invaded New Haven, Connecticut, as part of a strategic, largely failed, effort to draw George Washington's army into battle. About 2,600 British and Hessian troops landed, occupying the town, destroying military supplies, burning parts of East Haven, and taking Black Rock Fort.

Continental Militia units from surrounding towns, including those led by Captain Baldwin, mustered quickly to resist the British forces but were overwhelmed with over 2,600 British and Hessian soldiers.

Lineage: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Henry Sanford > Sarah Wheeler > Sarah Baldwin > Timothy Baldwin

The Quiet Work Behind Every Army: Dates Undetermined

Not every Patriot's contribution came at the point of a bayonet, and the seventh of the family's recognized Patriots represents a different, less visible kind of service, one without a battle or a muster date attached to it at all.

7. Joseph Neville O'Bannon 1758 – 1824

Joseph Neville O'Bannon was born on January 12, 1758, in Fauquier, Virginia. He married Martha Jane Welton in 1780, in Fauquier. They were the parents of at least 4 sons and 2 daughters. He died on December 10, 1824, in Jackson, Missouri, at the age of 66. His Irish Ancestors arrived in the late 1600s from County Tipperary, Ireland.

Joseph O'Bannon provided the Continental Army with wagons and wagoneers. The DAR recognizes him as a patriot even although he did not serve in the military because provisioning the Continental Army was important. Wagons were essential to move supplies and heavy military equipment of the Continental Army. His service is documented through claims record of reimbursement for items provided to the Continental troops during the Revolutionary War (see Abercrombie & Slatten, VA Rev Pub Claims, Vol 1, pp 347, 353 — Virginia Revolutionary "Publick" Claims, Volumes 1-3).

He is an example that there were many ways to serve one's patriotic duty.

Lineage: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Martha Jane Russell > Joseph William Russell > Elizabeth O'Bannon > Joseph O'Bannon

From Yorktown to Home: 1781–1783

Frizell had been in the fight since 1778, likely sailing aboard privateers he did not own, and his July 1781 commission to command the Galley Reprisal came just months before the moment most Americans think of as the war's end: the surrender of Lord Cornwallis's army at Yorktown Virginia, on October 19, 1781, after a combined American and French siege that trapped him against the York River with no hope of escape. It was, in fact, the last major land battle of the Revolution, and news of it reportedly drove the British prime minister to declare that it was all over.

It was not quite over. The British government did fall within months, but actual fighting, especially at sea, dragged on for nearly two more years, exactly the kind of work Frizell and his fellow privateers had been doing all along, while diplomats in Paris slowly hammered out the peace. Only on September 3, 1783, did Britain and the United States formally sign the Treaty of Paris, recognizing American independence outright. Even then, British troops held New York City, the last occupied American city, until November 25, 1783, when they finally evacuated and George Washington led his army back into the city he had been forced to abandon seven years earlier. A few weeks after that, on December 23, 1783, Washington resigned his commission to Congress and went home to Mount Vernon, closing out, at last, the war that Timothy Langdon's militia company had answered eight years and five months earlier on the coast of Maine.

By then, all seven of the family's Patriots had already returned to the ordinary business of living: raising families, building farms, and, in case after case, looking westward toward a new frontier in southeast Missouri, where their children and grandchildren would eventually settle alongside one another and where, two and a half centuries later, their descendants would gather to remember them together.

★ We are proud descendants of Patriots who built this nation ★

How Each Patriot Connects to Julia Sanford Vandivort

For anyone who wants to trace the exact line, here is how each of the seven Patriots connects down to Julia Sanford Vandivort, as recorded in Paul Stein's compilation. A few names repeat across more than one chain — a reminder of how often these seven families intermarried with one another over the generations.

Timothy Langdon: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Joseph William Russell > Mary Langdon Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Mary Langdon > Timothy Langdon

Jarvis Daugherty & William Daugherty: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Mary Daugherty > William Daugherty > Jarvis Daugherty

Daniel Sanford: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Henry Sanford > Eli Sanford > Daniel Sanford

Joseph Russell: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Martha Jane Russell > Joseph William Russell > James Russell > Joseph Russell

Captain Benjamin Frizell: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Joseph William Russell > Mary Langdon Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Joseph Frizell > Benjamin Frizell

Timothy Baldwin: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Sarah Wheeler > Sarah Baldwin > Timothy Baldwin
(Sarah Wheeler, Timothy Baldwin's granddaughter, married Eli Sanford — Daniel Sanford's son — in 1791, which is also how the Baldwin line joins the Sanford line above)

Joseph O'Bannon: Julia Sanford Vandivort > Linus Sanford > Martha Jane Russell > Joseph William Russell > Elizabeth O'Bannon > Joseph O'Bannon